

Tuesday, 1 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

22° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

20° 13°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

20° 13°

GLASGOW

Rain

16° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 There's been a major shake-up in the Conservative Party, with senior figures Mel Stride and Priti Patel reportedly replaced in a reshuffle.**
Conservative leader Kemi Badenoch is reportedly making changes to her top team. It comes ahead of the party's conference, which is scheduled for October.
POLITICS · UK
- 2 Hundreds of people have gathered to remember the victims of the Heaton Park synagogue attack, almost a year on from the incident.**
Among those attending the memorial event were the Chief Rabbi and Deputy Labour leader Angela Rayner. The attack shocked the community last year.
NATIONAL NEWS · UK
- 3 The Governor of the Bank of England, Andrew Bailey, has warned that Artificial Intelligence could trigger a global economic downturn.**
Mr Bailey issued the warning to G20 leaders, highlighting the potential for volatility. He cited energy shocks caused by the US-Iran conflict as a contributing factor.
ECONOMY · UK
- 4 A nursery in Aberdeen has been fined after a 10-month-old baby boy was severely burned by a bucket of bleach in 2021.**
The incident happened when the child came into contact with a bucket containing boiled water and bleach. The nursery has now faced a penalty for the incident.
NATIONAL NEWS · UK
- 5 More than 20 business groups are urging Scottish First Minister John Swinney to scrap his plan for a legal cap on food prices.**
They've written a joint letter, calling the proposed food and drink price cap 'ineffective'. The First Minister has been considering the measure to help with the cost of living.
POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 An actor who was told he had Alzheimer's is now performing a one-man show on a London stage.**
 Peter Marinker, 85, is taking on one of Samuel Beckett's most famous plays, 'Krapp's Last Tape'. It's a remarkable story of resilience and passion for theatre.
ON AIR – What an inspiring story! Have you ever overcome a major personal challenge to achieve something you thought was impossible?
 THEATRE · NOW
- 2 Scottish soap opera River City is set for a fiery finale, as the show prepares to air its last ever episode.**
 The Glasgow-based drama, set in the fictional district of Shieldinch, is coming to an end after 24 years. Fans are eagerly anticipating how the long-running series will conclude.
ON AIR – Are you a River City fan? What are your favourite memories from the show, and how do you hope it all ends?
 TV · SOON
- 3 The trailer has just dropped for the blockbuster film 'Children of Blood and Bone', starring Cynthia Erivo and Damson Idris.**
 The movie is based on the popular novel of the same name by Tomi Adeyemi. It's set to be a huge release, bringing the fantasy world to the big screen.
ON AIR – Are you looking forward to seeing 'Children of Blood and Bone'? What's your favourite book-to-screen adaptation?
 FILM · SOON
- 4 British singer Charli XCX brought an electrifying, era-spanning set to Reading Festival, headlining the first night.**
 She shared the headline slot with Irish rock band Fontaines DC, kicking off the festival's music. Fans enjoyed a mix of her hits from across her career.
ON AIR – Were you at Reading Festival this year? What was your highlight and who was your favourite act?
 MUSIC · PAST WEEKEND
- 5 Lola Young surprised crowds at Reading Festival with a last-minute set on the final day of the event.**
 The singer has been making a slow return to performing after taking a break last year. Her unexpected appearance was a treat for festival-goers.
ON AIR – Love a surprise gig! What's the best surprise performance you've ever seen, or who would you love to see pop up unannounced?
 MUSIC · PAST WEEKEND

On the schedule

- 1 Football legend Lionel Messi has announced his retirement from international duty with Argentina, saying he has 'nothing left to give'.**

The decision, which Messi described as 'hurtful', comes after a long and illustrious career representing his country. He feels the time is right to step away.

ON AIR – Messi retiring from international football... do you think he's made the right decision, or could he have gone on longer?

FOOTBALL · GLOBAL
- 2 Manchester City have reportedly agreed a massive £65 million deal to sign Iliman Ndiaye from Everton.**

The transfer fee is understood to be a minimum of £60 million for the Everton player. City are looking to strengthen their squad ahead of the new season.

ON AIR – Another big transfer for Man City! Is this a good move for them, and how do you think it will impact Everton?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Liverpool have completed a huge £123 million transfer for Bradley Barcola, the player nicknamed 'the grasshopper'.**

The BBC Sport team has been looking at how Barcola has overcome setbacks to reach the top. His family support has been key to his journey.

ON AIR – £123 million! That's a massive signing for Liverpool. Do you think he's worth the price tag, and what will he bring to the team?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 British qualifier Harriet Dart has ended a 19-month wait for a Grand Slam singles win at the US Open.**

Dart fought back impressively to beat Peyton Stearns in the first round of the tournament. It's a significant victory for the British player.

ON AIR – Great to see a British player doing well at the US Open! Who are you backing to go all the way in the tournament this year?

TENNIS · UK
- 5 Tottenham are reportedly in talks to sign Chelsea winger Mykhailo Mudryk on a season-long loan deal.**

This potential move would see Mudryk switch London clubs for the upcoming season. Both teams will be looking to finalise their squads before the transfer window closes.

ON AIR – Mudryk to Tottenham on loan – good move for him, or for Chelsea? And how do you think it will affect the rivalry between the two clubs?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Green-fingered enthusiasts are discovering the joy of 'micro-gardening' in tiny spaces.**
Even a small window ledge can become a thriving haven for herbs and miniature vegetables, proving you don't need acres to grow your own.
- 2 The humble 'picnic blanket' is seeing a resurgence as families embrace outdoor dining.**
From local parks to garden patches, people are finding simple pleasure in al fresco meals, rain or shine.
- 3 More people are learning the traditional craft of 'jam making' from seasonal fruits.**
It's a sweet way to preserve the taste of summer and share homemade delights with friends and family.
- 4 A new study suggests that 'looking at maps' can be a calming and meditative activity.**
Tracing routes and imagining journeys offers a quiet escape, even if you're not planning a trip.
- 5 The trend for 'repurposing old furniture' is growing, giving beloved items a new lease of life.**
Instead of buying new, people are painting, sanding, and reupholstering, adding character to their homes.
- 6 Community 'seed swap' events are blossoming, encouraging local biodiversity.**
Gardeners are exchanging seeds, sharing tips, and strengthening neighbourhood connections through their love of plants.
- 7 There's a renewed appreciation for the 'local market stall' and independent sellers.**
Shoppers are seeking out unique crafts, fresh produce, and friendly faces, supporting local economies.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, without actually opening the packet yet?

ANSWER: GIVING THE PACKET A GOOD 'RUSTLE' OR 'SHAKE' TO GAUGE THE CRISPINESS!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of freshly brewed tea, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: TAKING A REALLY DEEP 'SNIFF' OF THE DRY TEA LEAVES IN THE CADDY OR THE TEABAG BEFORE ADDING WATER!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem' of a local shop or a tiny café that you just can't believe you've never noticed before?**
What's that unexpected little place you've stumbled upon in your area that's now a firm favourite, and why do you love it?
- **We all have those 'everyday sounds' that just make us feel instantly at home or bring a smile to our face, don't we?**
What's that particular sound in your home or neighbourhood that's surprisingly comforting or always signals that everything's just right?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is charmingly known as a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which helps them identify edible plants from a distance.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public art gallery was established in Basel, Switzerland, in 1661.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A 'quaternity' is the collective noun for a group of badgers.
- The inventor of the Pringle's can is buried in one, as per his request.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as three-dimensional wallpaper.
- There are more public libraries in the UK than there are McDonald's restaurants.
- The 'ding' sound you hear when your computer starts up was originally composed by Brian Eno.

On this day

Day 244 of the year, 121 days left in 2026. Today Feast of Creation (Christianity); Christian feast day: Constantius (Costanzo) of Aquino; Christian feast day: David Pendleton Oakerhater (Anglican Communion); Christian feast day: Giles. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Clare Connor, English cricketer
- 1990 — Aisling Loftus, English actress
- 1928 — George Maharis, American actor, singer, and artist (died 2023)
- 1961 — Boney James, American saxophonist, composer and producer
- 1984 — Joe Trohman, American singer-songwriter, guitarist and producer
- 1944 — Leonard Slatkin, American conductor and composer
- 1963 — Grant-Lee Phillips, American musician and actor
- 1948 — Greg Errico, American drummer and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1873 — Cetshwayo ascends to the throne as king of the Zulu nation following the death of his father Mpande.
- 1894 — Over 400 people die in the Great Hinckley Fire, a forest fire in Hinckley, Minnesota.
- 1862 — American Civil War: Confederate forces under General Stonewall Jackson inflict heavy casualties in the Battle of Chantilly during the Union withdrawal from the Northern Virginia campaign.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1838 — Saint Andrew's Scots School, the oldest school of British origin in South America, is established.
- 2008 — Iraq War: The United States Armed Forces transfers control of Anbar Province to the Iraqi Armed Forces.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1969 — A coup in Libya brings Muammar Gaddafi to power.
- 1836 — Narcissa Whitman, one of the first English-speaking white women to settle west of the Rocky Mountains, arrives at Walla Walla, Washington.

- 1873 — Cetshwayo ascends to the throne as king of the Zulu nation following the death of his father Mpande.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 245 of the year, 120 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Acepshimas of Hnaita and companions (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Agricola of Avignon; Christian feast day: Antoninus of Pamiers; Christian feast day: Brocard. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Jonathan Kite, American actor and comedian
- 1975 — Jill Janus, American singer (died 2018)
- 1967 — Frank Fontseré, American drummer and songwriter
- 1929 — Victor Spinetti, Welsh actor and director (died 2012)
- 1981 — Chris Tremlett, English cricketer
- 1968 — Cynthia Watros, American actress
- 1966 — Salma Hayek, Mexican-American actress, director, and producer
- 1934 — Sam Gooden, American soul singer (died 2022)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Swissair Flight 111 crashes near Peggy's Cove, Nova Scotia; all 229 people on board are killed.
- 2024 — A suicide bombing in Kabul, Afghanistan, kills 6 people and injures 13.
- 1985 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Tamil politicians and former MPs M. Alalasundaram and V. Dharmalingam are shot dead.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1984 — Seven people are shot and killed and 12 wounded in the Milperra massacre, a shootout between the rival motorcycle gangs Bandidos and Comancheros in Sydney, Australia.
- 1968 — Operation OAU begins during the Nigerian Civil War.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar